

L2A™

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(c) Case Study

As per PV Young, case study is the indepth analysis of a social unit and obtaining total information about a social phenomenon.

History

- 1) Fredric Le Play used case study method for the first time in 1855.
- 2) Herbert Spencer used it for first time in ~~anthropologi~~ ethnographic studies.
- 3) Thomas popularised it in his work 'The Polish Peasant (1918)'

Case study

Lora Du Bois used case study approach in her study of Ador, East Indian community and came up with the concept of Modal Personality.

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Advantages

- in depth analysis of a cultural variations
- helps to study cultural & social change
- Various ~~or~~ important events like enculturation & socialization can be recorded
- Rites de passage can be easily recorded
- ~~not~~ It can help develop various theories & methodologies.

Limitations

- issues of personal bias
- observational errors
- difficulty in comparing
- no proper standardisation

Despite all this, case study have been
hallmark of: anthropological data collection.